**Teacher copy.** Contains answer keys and grading guidance. Do not publish to students.

Optima Academy Online
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# Teacher Manual

M/J Visual Art 3 · CPALMS Course Code 0101120 · Grade 8 · Full-Year Studio Elective

**Structure:** 20 two-week studio modules, 4 quarters of 5 modules each

**Delivery:** On-Demand (asynchronous) and Live (synchronous) sections, shared content

**Manual date:** July 14, 2026

SEMESTER 2 FORMAT (REVISED 2026-10-14)

Semester 2 (Modules 11–20) was revised after this manual was written. Each Semester 2 module now runs six items in this order: **Instructional Page**; **NN.01 Sketch** (10 pts, completion); **NN.02 VR** (10 pts, completion; VR is optional: students who cannot complete it in VR complete the same task outside VR and submit the same evidence); **NN.03 Discussion Board** (graded, 10 pts: original post with visual evidence 4, two art vocabulary words 2, two replies 4; turn on "Users must post before seeing replies"); **NN.04 Studio Project & Reflection** (formerly Artwork + Artist Statement, 100 pts, same rubric); **NN.05 Short Quiz** (10 pts, auto-graded). Semester 2 modules have no intro or outro surveys. Each module's teacher cycle plan lists the discussion template, its prompt, and the VR task.

Where this manual says the course has no VR, no discussion forum, or intro/outro surveys in every module, read that as describing **Semester 1** only.

## How to use this manual

This is a standalone, teacher-only document. It is not part of the student-facing course and should never be linked, pasted, or exported into a student-visible Canvas

page. It documents the course exactly as built in `04_Final` — every count, rubric, and quote below was read directly out of the finished course files, not assumed. Anything the build team could not verify from the files themselves is marked [VERIFY]; treat those as open items for the course lead, not settled facts.

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SECTION 1

# How this course works

## A typical lesson — walked through top to bottom (Module 1, "The Elements of Art")

Every `01_Week1_Instructional-Page.html` in the course follows the same skeleton. A teacher who has read one has read the shape of all twenty. In order, the page reads:

| Part | What it is | Graded touchpoint? |
|---|---|---|
| Header + metadata strip | Optima branding, quarter/module/lesson labels, module theme. | No |
| 📖 Today's Focus | Framing question and short intro paragraph for the day's content. | No |
| 🎯 By the end of this lesson you will be able to… | Three numbered objectives. | No |
| 📋 What you need for this lesson | Home-accessible materials list. | No |
| 👀 Part 1 · Look First | The **Quick Check-In** widget opens with the notice-and-wonder framing ("What do you see? What do you notice? What do you wonder?"), then the featured artwork (embedded image or, for a living artist, a link-out box) with a short caption, then narrative context. | No — ungraded, immediate feedback only |
| 📘 Part 2 · Name What You See | Core-concept visual (e.g. the seven-Elements chart), named subsections, a "Helpful to Know" callout, and a **Try It** self-check widget. | No |
| 🔍 Part 3 · Watch It Work | The four-step critique walkthrough — Describe, Analyze, Interpret filled in by the lesson; Judge left as a commit-then-reveal element the student opens after thinking it through themselves. (The four steps | No |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | are taught without naming the acronym that used to label them — see Section 12.) | |
| 📝 Vocabulary From This Lesson | The lesson's key terms box; the rubric later grades vocabulary use in the Artist Statement. | Indirectly, via Week 2 rubric |
| ➡️ What You'll Do Next | Three numbered next steps: Sketch warm-up, Quiz, Week 2 project. | Links to the graded items below |
| 💪 The Big Idea | Closing wrap-up paragraph. | No |
| Footer | Course/brand footer. | No |

*The instructional page itself is ungraded and GitHub-deployed (see Section 2). Everything after "What You'll Do Next" is where the tiered, gradable items begin.*

## A typical week

Every module is a two-week cycle. Both weeks are identical in shape across all 20 modules — this course does not vary its rhythm module to module.

| Segment | What the student does | Graded? | Tier |
|---|---|---|---|
| Module opens | Intro survey (Essential Question first answer + module-goals acknowledgment) | Ungraded / completion | Tier 4 |
| Week 1 | Read the instructional page (GitHub-deployed, interactive) | No | — |
| Week 1 | Complete the Sketch Assignment (Canvas RCE) | Completion, 10 pts | Tier 1 |
| Week 1 | Take the Week 1 Quiz (Canvas New Quiz, auto-graded) | Auto-graded, 20 pts | Tier 1 |
| Week 2 | Build the finished studio Artwork and write the Artist Statement (single submission) | Teacher rubric, 100 pts — **the one teacher-graded event per cycle** | Tier 3 |
| Module closes | Outro survey (Essential Question revisited, confidence rating, "what's still unclear," virtue reflection) | Ungraded / completion | Tier 4 |

There is no discussion forum and no Tier 2 item anywhere in this course's built cycle — see Section 7 for the explicit confirmation.

## Major assessments — every Tier 3 item in the course

Every module carries exactly one Tier 3 assessment: the Week 2 Studio Artwork + Artist Statement, 100 points, scored on the single shared rubric described in Section 6. Names below use the verified module titles; where a specific project name was confirmed in the build (Modules 1, 4, 11, 14, 18), that name is used.

| Mod | Title | Week 2 assessment | Pts | Grading time (per student, roughly) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Elements of Art | Elements of Art Review Booklet + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 2 | Ancient Greece (Greek Columns) | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 3 | Ancient Rome (Mosaic) | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 4 | Day of the Dead (Sugar Skulls) | Sugar Skull Design + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 5 | Dragon's Eye | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 6 | Italian Renaissance (Perspective) | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 7 | Color Theory (Silhouette Skyline) | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 8 | Analogous Colors (Mexican Cacti) | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 9 | Value (Tim Burton Snowmen) | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 10 | Snow Globes (Watercolor) | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5–7 min (wet-media drying/pacing) |
| 11 | Space Art (Glimpsing Galaxies) | Galaxy Painting + broken-wall overlay + Artist Statement | 100 | ~7 min (extra collage step to check) |
| 12 | Post-Impressionism (Van Gogh Pop-Up Chairs) | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 13 | Monochromatic (Picasso) | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 14 | Pop Art Cerealism (Michael Albert) | Cereal-Box Cut & Collage + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 15 | Pop Art Warhol (Relief Printing) | Studio Artwork (relief print) + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 16 | Grant Wood (American Gothic Parody) | Studio Artwork (parody) + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 17 | Digital Art (Half Cartoon Portrait) | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 18 | Clay Relief | Clay Relief (signed on back) + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5–7 min (drying/pacing + hand tools) |
| 19 | Op Art (Bridget Riley) | Studio Artwork + Artist Statement | 100 | ~5 min |
| 20 | End of Year Review | Year-Long Portfolio Curation + Growth Reflection | 100 | ~10–12 min (reviewing a full year of work) |

*Grading-time estimates are the build team's planning judgment based on rubric length and item complexity, not a measured average — treat as a rough planning aid, not a guarantee.*

> **MATERIALS LEAD-TIME FLAG**
>
> Module 18 (Clay Relief) is the one module where teachers should give families advance notice: it needs air-dry clay (e.g. Crayola Model Magic) or a home-mixed salt-dough substitute, which is worth announcing a cycle ahead so it's on hand by Week 2. Everything else in the course materials list is standard household paper/pencil/color-media supplies, plus a foam tray (Module 15), clean recyclable packaging (Module 14), paint/brush/old toothbrush (Module 11), and a device with a free drawing app or paper fallback (Module 17) — none of which need advance ordering.

SECTION 2

# Ungraded interactives & the intro/outro wrappers

## Ungraded interactive activities

Every instructional page carries two to three small interactive widgets: the **Quick Check-In** (the notice-and-wonder opening on the featured artwork), the **Try It** self-check on the day's Elements/Principles content, and the **Judge** step of the critique walkthrough, built as a commit-then-reveal element the student opens only after forming their own answer. None of these produce a Canvas submission and none need grading. They cost the teacher nothing directly — they are formation-by-practice, not busywork to chase down. If a student skips them, it shows up indirectly, in weaker quiz performance or a thinner Artist Statement, not as a missing grade.

Living/rights-managed artists (Vija Celmins, Module 11; Michael Albert, Module 14; Andy Warhol, Module 15; Bridget Riley and Victor Vasarely, Module 19) are handled the same way as every other featured artist in the Look First step, except the image itself is a clean link-out box to the museum's or artist's own page rather than an embedded picture — because none of these four are in the public domain. Module 11's box, for example, tells the student plainly: "*Vija Celmins is a living artist, and her work is protected by copyright. We link to the museum's own collection page rather than reproduce the image here.*" This is worth knowing going in: a student asking "why is this one just a link" is not missing content, they are seeing the course's copyright convention working as designed.

## Intro/outro wrappers — Canvas Quizzes, not pages

Both wrappers are built as **Canvas New Quizzes in survey mode** (Tier 4, ungraded or completion credit), never as wiki pages and never custom-coded. This matters because survey-mode Quiz results are sortable and exportable — a teacher serving roughly 500 students cannot read 500 individual reflections, but can scan a column of confidence ratings or export every "what's still unclear" answer in one pass.

| | Captures | Question type |
|---|---|---|
| **Intro** (opens the module) | Essential Question — first answer | Essay / long answer |
| | Module-goals acknowledgment | Multiple choice (single answer) |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Outro** (closes the module) | Essential Question — revisited, compared to the first answer | Essay / long answer |
| | Confidence rating on the module's key focus (early-warning signal) | Likert 1–5 |
| | **"What still feels unclear"** — the single highest-leverage item in the whole course | Short answer / essay |
| | Virtue reflection (any of the 7 virtues, plus a one-sentence follow-up) | Multiple choice + essay follow-up |

Note what is deliberately absent: there is no group/partner option anywhere in the intro survey. This was removed course-wide in the July 2026 revision pass — see Section 3 for why that trade-off matters for one specific standard.

> THE HIGHEST-LEVERAGE 15–20 MINUTES IN THE COURSE
>
> After each module closes, spend 15–20 minutes triaging the outro results before moving on. Sort the confidence column for clusters of 1s and 2s — that is your early-warning list. Skim the "what's still unclear" column for the same phrase repeating across several students — that is a concept to re-teach, in an announcement or a short Ignite-AI-drafted note, before the next module opens. This single habit catches confusion while it is still cheap to fix.

SECTION 3

# AI & VR in this course (student-facing)

## AI

[VERIFY] — GAP FOUND

A representative sample of ten lesson and artwork pages spanning both semesters (Modules 1, 4, 9, 11, 14, 16, 17) was searched for any mention of AI, artificial intelligence, or an AI-awareness callout box. **None was found anywhere in the sample.** This course, as currently built, does not yet carry the gold AI-awareness callouts that other Optima courses use. Per Optima's standing policy — AI awareness, not required tool use; callouts stay factual about what AI can and cannot do for a task, never persuasive — this is a real gap the course lead should consciously decide whether to close before the course goes live to families, not an oversight to paper over here. Until it is closed, a teacher should not describe this course as having AI-awareness content, because it currently does not.

## VR

**Semester 2 update (2026-10-14):** every Semester 2 module now has an NN.02 VR item, optional by design, with a full outside-VR path; see the Semester 2 format note at the top of this manual. The rest of this paragraph describes Semester 1. Semester 1 has **no VR content of any kind**, and that is by design, not an oversight. A synchronous VR session ran alongside the Week 1 Quiz in an earlier draft of every module; it was removed course-wide in the July 2026 revision pass, along with its file ( `03_Week1_VR-Session.html` ) and every reference to it in the surviving files. If a teacher sees an old syllabus, an older module list, or a returning family asking about a "VR session," the accurate answer is that this course does not currently use VR at all — nothing further to configure or explain.

This trade-off is not free: the VR session used to host a spoken, small-group critique conversation. Removing it (along with the group/partner option on the intro survey) means the course no longer has a built-in collaborative-discussion component. See

Section 11 for the one standard this affects (ELA.K12.EE.4.1) and why it is flagged as an intentional, not accidental, gap.

SECTION 4

# Using Ignite AI to support students (teacher-facing)

> [VERIFY] BEFORE USING
>
> Ignite AI's exact feature names and availability vary by Canvas release and by what Optima has enabled on this instance. Everything below is described functionally — confirm the specific button or menu exists in your Canvas before promising it to yourself or a colleague.

This section is the course lead's chosen structure: one comprehensive section, rather than a short version plus a per-module flag. Every use below is governed by two standing rules: **coach, not catch** (Section 8), and **AI drafts, the teacher decides** — the teacher always reads, edits, and owns anything before it reaches a student or family. Ignite AI is never used to surveil, rank, or auto-penalize a student.

## 1. Drafting individualized feedback

For the Week 2 rubric (Section 6), draft the four rubric-row comments from a quick read of the student's artwork photo and Artist Statement, then edit for accuracy and voice before posting. This keeps ~5-minute-per-student grading honest while making the written feedback feel personal rather than templated.

## 2. Summarizing wrapper analytics

Feed the outro survey's confidence ratings and "what's still unclear" free-text into Ignite AI and ask for a one-paragraph summary of the cohort's sticking points before you write the next announcement. This turns the Section 2 triage habit from a full read into a fast first pass — you still skim the raw responses, but you start from a summary instead of a blank page.

## 3. Surfacing students who need a nudge

Ask Ignite AI to flag students with a low outro confidence rating, a missed Week 1 quiz or sketch, or a declining pattern across recent modules, and draft a warm, specific check-in message for each. Read and personalize every draft before sending — this is a nudge, not a citation.

### 4. Generating practice variants

For a student who needs another rep on a Tier 1 skill (say, identifying value contrast after a low quiz score on Module 9), ask Ignite AI to generate a short additional practice prompt in the same style as the Sketch Assignment, rather than reassigning the identical item.

### 5. Communicating with families

Use Ignite AI to draft clear, kind progress summaries or to translate a message into a family's home language, then review before sending. This is especially useful ahead of Module 4 and Module 18, where the family scripts in Sections 13 and 1 give you a starting point to adapt.

SECTION 5

# Grading categories & Canvas gradebook setup

## Grading categories (assignment groups)

The course's own syllabus draft sets a confirmed 60/30/10 weighted split. Because every module's raw point totals are identical (10 + 20 + 100 = 130 graded points, with wrappers carrying no points), this only works as a **weighted** gradebook (Canvas Assignment Group weighting), not a raw-points total — set it up as weighted, not as "total points."

| Assignment group | Maps to | Weight |
|---|---|---|
| Major Studio Projects & Artist Statements | Tier 3 — Week 2 Artwork + Statement | 60% |
| Sketchbook, Sketches & Quizzes | Tier 1 — Week 1 Sketch Assignment + Quiz | 30% |
| Reflections, Critiques & Wrapper Surveys | Tier 4 — Intro/Outro surveys | 10% |

## Step-by-step Canvas setup

1. Course > Grades > gear icon > **Assignment Groups**. Create the three groups above.
2. Turn on **"Weight final grade based on assignment groups"** and enter 60 / 30 / 10.
3. Set the grading scheme to the standard Optima letter-grade scheme (school-wide; confirm the current scheme name with the registrar if unsure — `[VERIFY]`).
4. When building each Week 2 Artwork + Statement assignment, attach the rubric (Section 6) as a native Canvas Rubric so SpeedGrader scores it directly, and set it to 100 points in the Major Studio Projects group.
5. Mark both wrapper quizzes as **ungraded survey** (or completion-only if you want them to show on the gradebook as a completion checkmark) — never as a points-based quiz.

6. Set the Sketch Assignment to **Complete/Incomplete** grading (10 pts on completion) rather than a points scale that implies artistic judgment — Week 1 work is a practice rung, not the graded event.
7. Set a course-wide late/missing policy consistent with the school's standard policy (confirm current wording with your department; not something this manual should invent).

## Gradebook map — every graded item

| Item | Assignment group | Points | Method |
|---|---|---|---|
| Week 1 Sketch Assignment | Sketchbook, Sketches & Quizzes | 10 | Completion |
| Week 1 Quiz | Sketchbook, Sketches & Quizzes | 20 | Auto-graded (Canvas New Quiz) |
| Week 2 Artwork + Artist Statement | Major Studio Projects & Artist Statements | 100 | Native Canvas Rubric |
| Module Intro survey | Reflections, Critiques & Wrapper Surveys | — (survey/completion) | Survey / completion |
| Module Outro survey | Reflections, Critiques & Wrapper Surveys | — (survey/completion) | Survey / completion |

*This row pattern repeats identically for all 20 modules — 100 rows of the same five items, module number swapped. Build one module's items, then duplicate the assignment shells for the rest.*

## Module-progress view

Use Canvas's **Module Requirements / student progress** view as your at-a-glance completion signal for the ungraded scaffolding (instructional page view, widget completion where trackable). It will not tell you if a student engaged thoughtfully, only whether they opened the item — pair it with the outro triage in Section 2 for the real signal.

SECTION 6

# Rubrics for every teacher-graded item

FREE-RESPONSE QUIZ ANSWER GUIDES — NOT NEEDED

All twenty Week 1 Quizzes were read in full. Every one is built entirely from Canvas-native auto-gradable types — multiple choice, true/false, and matching — 8 questions each (10 in Module 20's cumulative review). **Zero free-response, short-answer, or essay items exist in any Week 1 Quiz in this course.** Every quiz file states plainly that it "grades itself with no teacher pass," and that claim holds up in every file. This section therefore needs no free-response answer guide for the quizzes — the only teacher-scored item in the entire course is the one Week 2 rubric below.

## The Standard Module Rubric

Every module's Week 2 Artwork + Artist Statement is scored on the same 5-criterion, 100-point rubric, embedded directly in each module's `04_Week2_Artwork-ArtistStatement.html` file under a "GRADING RUBRIC" heading. It was confirmed byte-for-byte identical in structure across Modules 1, 4, and 18 (a spread across both semesters), with three of the five rows using the exact same performance-level wording every time.

| Criterion | 4 — Excellent | 3 — Proficient | 2 — Developing | 1 — Beginning | Pts |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Elements & Principles** | *Project-specific — the descriptor text is written to the module's own content (e.g. line/shape/color for Module 1; symmetry/pattern for Module 4). Read the embedded rubric in that module's file for the exact wording.* | | | | 20 |
| **Craftsmanship & Technique** | "Exceptional care…" (full phrase in-file) | "Competent and neat with minor issues." | "Uneven execution; rushed in places." | "Little care or effort evident." | 20 |
| **Creative Problem-Solving** | "Original, thoughtful… | "Some original thinking in | "Follows directions, little | "Minimal engagement | 20 |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | clear personal choices/voice." | the designs." | personal voice." | with the task." | |
| **Artist Statement** | "Specific and personal; uses art vocabulary." | "Clear, with some specific detail." | "Vague or general." | "Minimal or missing." | 20 |
| **Completion & Signature** | *Project-specific — e.g. Module 18 (Clay Relief) specifically checks "signed on the back," since a relief has a back to sign; most modules simply check the work is complete and signed.* | | | | 20 |
| | | | | **Total** | **100** |

**Why only two rows vary:** "Elements & Principles" and "Completion & Signature" are written to fit each project's specific technique and format; "Craftsmanship & Technique," "Creative Problem-Solving," and "Artist Statement" are worded identically every time on purpose, so grading stays fast and consistent at roughly 5 minutes per student. Nothing further needs to be built here — the rubric already exists in every module; paste each one into its Canvas assignment as a **native Canvas Rubric** so it scores directly in SpeedGrader.

## Subject-specific rubrics beyond the standard one

This course does not need a separate essay, lab-report, or performance-task rubric: the Artist Statement is already folded into the single studio rubric above as its own 20-point row, so there is one unified rubric type reused across all 20 modules rather than a family of different rubric shapes.

SECTION 7

# Quizzes & assessment activities — how to run & grade

**NO DISCUSSION FORUMS IN THIS COURSE**

This course's built cycle contains no Tier 2 discussion-forum item in any module. The per-cycle item set is exactly five things: instructional page (ungraded), Sketch Assignment (Tier 1), Quiz (Tier 1), Artwork + Artist Statement (Tier 3), and the intro/outro survey pair (Tier 4). This section is scoped to what actually exists rather than a generic discussion-grading guide the course has no use for.

## General guidance, by type

| Type | What it is / how it's scored | Teacher move |
|---|---|---|
| Ungraded lesson interactives (Quick Check-In, Try It, the Judge reveal) | Immediate self-feedback; no submission | Nothing to grade. If quiz/statement quality is weak, that's the signal a student skipped these — address it there, not by chasing the widget. |
| Week 1 Sketch Assignment | Completion, 10 pts, Canvas RCE | Check that something was submitted and attempted; this is a practice rung, not a quality check. |
| Week 1 Quiz | Auto-graded, 20 pts, 8–10 items, 100% MC/True-False/Matching | Nothing to grade by hand. Skim the item analysis if Canvas offers it, to see which question the cohort missed most — that's a preview of the outro's "unclear" answers. |
| Week 2 Artwork + Artist Statement | Teacher rubric, 100 pts, one submission | Score against the Section 6 rubric; lead comments with what's working, per Section 8. |
| Intro/Outro wrapper surveys | Ungraded/completion, Canvas Quiz survey mode | Don't grade content; triage the outro per Section 2. |

## Per-instance notes — where a module's Tier 3 item needs something specific

Most modules need nothing beyond the standard rubric. The rows below flag the ones where the built assignment has an extra, specific thing to check for.

| Mod | What to specifically check when grading this one |
|---|---|
| 1 | Standard rubric. No customization beyond the wording already in-file. |
| 2–3 | Standard rubric. |
| 4 | Standard rubric; Completion row checks the design was treated with the respectful framing taught in the lesson (celebratory, not "scary"). |
| 5–6 | Standard rubric. |
| 7 | Standard rubric. Note for yourself before teaching: the dry-brush technique applies only to painting the water reflection, never to mixing the sky colors — don't mark down a student for not dry-brushing the sky. |
| 8–9 | Standard rubric. |
| 10 | Standard rubric; allow drying time before the Artist Statement is written (watercolor). |
| 11 | **Confirm the broken-wall overlay is present** — the assignment has an explicit added step where students cut an oval "broken wall" piece and glue it over their galaxy painting. A submission missing this step is missing a required part of the task, not just weaker craftsmanship. |
| 12 | Standard rubric; statement should reference the pendant-pair comparison (Van Gogh's Chair / Gauguin's Chair). |
| 13 | Standard rubric. |
| 14 | **Confirm the task is a cut-and-collage from real packaging**, not a drawn bold shape — the assignment was corrected during the build to describe cutting up a cereal box (or similar) and collaging the pieces, so a submission that is only a drawing has not completed the actual task. |
| 15 | Standard rubric (relief print). |
| 16 | Standard rubric; statement should name what was deliberately changed from the original composition (the point of a parody). |
| 17 | Standard rubric (digital or paper-fallback both acceptable). |
| 18 | **Allow drying time** before the piece is signed and photographed; Completion row specifically checks "signed on the back." Budget extra time for teacher safety guidance around carving tools (see Section 10). |
| 19 | Standard rubric. |
| 20 | Not a new-technique project — this is a portfolio curation + growth reflection across the full year. Expect longer per-student review time; there is no single new rubric row to |

check, but the Artist Statement row here is really a year-long growth reflection.

SECTION 8

## Coach, not catch

The teacher's job is to move each student forward, not to detect and punish. In practice, in this course:

- **Lead with what's working.** Rubric comments name the next concrete step (e.g. "add more value contrast in the shadow side" ), not just where a criterion fell short.
- **Tier 1 is a practice tool.** Allow a re-attempt on the Sketch Assignment or a Quiz retake if a student clearly rushed or misread the content — it exists to build the skill for Week 2, not to gatekeep it.
- **Use the outro triage and Ignite AI to find students early** (Sections 2 and 4), then reach out — never to build a case against a student.
- **On suspected AI misuse or academic dishonesty** in an Artist Statement: open a conversation first. Ask the student to talk through their process and choices. Treat it as a formation moment, not an accusation. This is especially relevant given this course has no built-in AI-awareness callout yet (Section 3) — a student may not know where the line is if it has never been named to them.
- **Public comments model good thinking** — if you share strong Artist Statements or artwork as examples, choose ones that model the thinking you want to spread; don't hold up weak work for public critique.

SECTION 9

# Weekly announcement scripts

SCOPING DECISION — STATED, NOT SILENT

This is a 20-module course. Rather than hand-write 20 full scripts (mostly repeating the same shape with different nouns), this section gives the reusable template, one fully drafted example per quarter (4 total, chosen to show the template flexing across different content types), and a compact one-line "hook" for all 20 modules a teacher can drop into the template in under a minute.

## Reusable template — clone for any module

TEMPLATE

**Subject:** Module [N] is open — [Module Title]

Hi Artists,
This week we're moving into Module [N]: [Module Title]. [One-line hook — see table below].
By [day], you should have read the instructional page and finished your Week 1 sketch. The one thing not to miss this cycle: [due date] — [the Week 2 Artwork + Artist Statement / the tricky concept to watch for].
[One warm, specific line of encouragement.]
— [Teacher name]

## Drafted example — Quarter 1 (Module 4, Day of the Dead)

**Subject:** Module 4 is open — Day of the Dead (Sugar Skulls)

Hi Artists,
This week we're moving into Module 4: Day of the Dead. We're looking at how one design can hold both celebration and remembrance at the same time — and how a sugar skull's bright pattern is a way of honoring someone, not a scary image.
By Wednesday, you should have read the instructional page and finished your

Week 1 sketch. The one thing not to miss this cycle: your Sugar Skull Design + Artist Statement is due [due date] — take your time with the symmetry, it's the heart of this one.
Looking forward to seeing the care you put into these.
— [Teacher name]

### Drafted example — Quarter 2 (Module 9, Value / Tim Burton Snowmen)

**Subject:** Module 9 is open — Value (Tim Burton Snowmen)

Hi Artists,
This week we're moving into Module 9: Value. Shades of gray alone can make a flat drawing look round, solid, and full of mood — you'll see it in a Rembrandt etching as well as in your own snowman.
By Wednesday, you should have read the instructional page and finished your Week 1 sketch. The one thing not to miss: your value scale needs a real range from lightest light to darkest dark before Week 2 — that's what the quiz and the project both check.
A little contrast goes a long way this week.
— [Teacher name]

### Drafted example — Quarter 3 (Module 14, Pop Art Cerealism)

**Subject:** Module 14 is open — Pop Art Cerealism (Michael Albert)

Hi Artists,
This week we're moving into Module 14: Pop Art Cerealism. Can the throwaway packaging from your kitchen become a work of art? This one is a cut-and-collage project, not a drawing — save a clean cereal or cracker box now so you have it ready for Week 2.
By Wednesday, you should have read the instructional page and finished your Week 1 sketch. The one thing not to miss: the Week 2 project asks you to cut up and collage real packaging, so hold onto a box this week.
Can't wait to see what you build out of something you'd normally recycle.
— [Teacher name]

## Drafted example — Quarter 4 (Module 18, Clay Relief)

> **Subject:** Module 18 is open — Clay Relief
>
> Hi Artists,
> This week we're moving into Module 18: Clay Relief. A flat slab, only inches deep, can make figures look like they stand far apart in space — that's the trick Ghiberti pulled off on the Gates of Paradise, and it's the one you're trying this cycle.
> By Wednesday, make sure you have air-dry clay (like Model Magic) or the salt-dough substitute on hand, since this project needs real drying time before the Artist Statement. Start your relief a day or two earlier than usual so it's dry in time.
> This is a hands-on one — enjoy the mess.
> — [Teacher name]

## Situational scripts

| Situation | Script |
|---|---|
| Mid-module check-in | "If your confidence on last module's outro was a 1 or 2, this is your reminder that [office hours / a message to me] are open before this cycle's project is due. A quick question now saves a harder fix later." |
| Pre-major-assessment reminder | "Your Week 2 Artwork + Artist Statement is due [due date]. Re-read the rubric before you submit — the Artist Statement is worth as much as the artwork itself, so don't leave it for the last five minutes." |
| Re-engagement nudge (quiet students) | "Hi [student name], I noticed you haven't opened Module [N] yet. No judgment — just checking in. Reply here or message me if something's in the way; I'd rather help now than have you fall behind." |

## One-line hooks — all 20 modules

| Mod | Title | Hook |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Elements of Art | The seven building blocks behind every artwork ever made. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 2 | Ancient Greece (Greek Columns) | Make a flat drawing trick the eye into looking round and solid. |
| 3 | Ancient Rome (Mosaic) | Hundreds of tiny colored pieces, one powerful picture. |
| 4 | Day of the Dead (Sugar Skulls) | One design, both celebration and remembrance. |
| 5 | Dragon's Eye | Make something that doesn't exist look real enough to touch. |
| 6 | Italian Renaissance (Perspective) | Open a deep room on a flat page. |
| 7 | Color Theory (Silhouette Skyline) | A mixed-color sky and a single bold silhouette, working together. |
| 8 | Analogous Colors (Mexican Cacti) | Neighbor colors on the wheel, one lively unified design. |
| 9 | Value (Tim Burton Snowmen) | Shades of gray alone, and a flat drawing turns round and moody. |
| 10 | Snow Globes (Watercolor) | Soft washes pull a whole little world into one glass globe. |
| 11 | Space Art (Glimpsing Galaxies) | Capture the swirl and depth of a galaxy in paint. |
| 12 | Post-Impressionism (Van Gogh Pop-Up Chairs) | An empty chair becomes a portrait of the person who sits in it. |
| 13 | Monochromatic (Picasso) | How much can one color say, in every shade of it? |
| 14 | Pop Art Cerealism (Michael Albert) | Kitchen packaging becomes a work of art. |
| 15 | Pop Art Warhol (Relief Printing) | One shape, repeated, and the space around it. |
| 16 | Grant Wood (American Gothic Parody) | Copying a famous painting on purpose, and making it your own. |
| 17 | Digital Art (Half Cartoon Portrait) | The same face, drawn real on one side, stylized on the other. |
| 18 | Clay Relief | A slab only inches deep that reads as far, deep space. |
| 19 | Op Art (Bridget Riley) | Still lines on a still page, tricking the eye into motion. |
| 20 | End of Year Review | A year of growth, curated into one portfolio. |

SECTION 10

# Teacher workflow & workload map

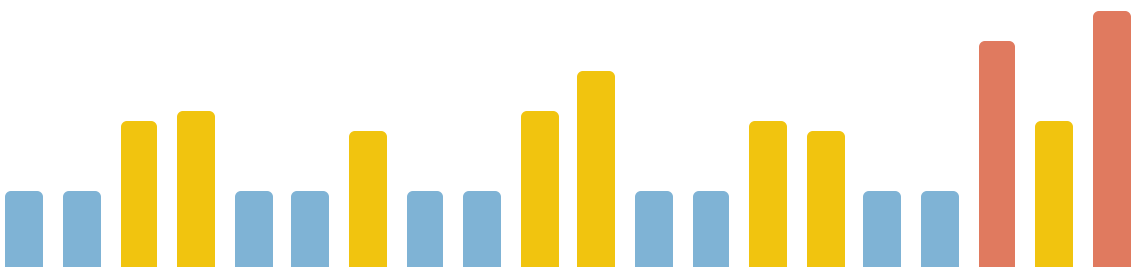
## A normal week's teacher tasks, in order

1. Triage the outro survey from the module that just closed (15–20 min — Section 2).
2. Grade the cycle's Week 2 Artwork + Artist Statement submissions in a batch against the standard rubric (~5–12 min/student depending on the module — Section 6/7).
3. Post the weekly announcement (Section 9).
4. Answer student/family messages, using Ignite AI drafts where helpful (Section 4).
5. Spot-check Week 1 Sketch/Quiz completion via the module-progress view for anyone falling behind (Section 5).

Time budget per item, per the course-wide Optima standard: roughly 0 hours for Tier 1 (auto-graded/completion), 8–12 hours spread across the whole cohort for a Tier 3 item over its grading window, and no Tier 2 hours in this course since it has no discussion forum.

## Where the extra time goes — heavy modules

Because every module carries the identical graded-item mix (one Tier 1 completion sketch, one Tier 1 auto-graded quiz, one Tier 3 rubric project, two Tier 4 surveys), the raw *count* of graded touchpoints is flat across all 20 modules — no module has more graded items than another. What actually varies is teacher *prep and logistics* time, based on what's already documented in this course's build: thin or missing safety language the teacher should supplement verbally, drying-time materials that shift the Week 2 pacing, living-artist copyright explanations, and the cumulative scope of the final review.






Light — standard cycle, nothing extra to plan

Moderate — one specific prep/logistics item to handle

Heavy — multiple factors stack, or a longer per-student review

*Heights reflect teacher prep/logistics load, not grading-item counts (which are identical every module) or invented hour figures — see the per-module tooltip for the specific reason. Modules 3, 11, and 18 are flagged because the built course's safety language is thin or absent for the cutting/carving tools those modules use.*

SECTION 11

# Standards coverage map

This map reflects a completed CPALMS standards audit against the built course. Codes and verdicts are reported as audited; nothing here is re-derived or invented.

## By standard

| Code | Description (paraphrase) | Verdict | Modules / notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| VA.68.C.2.1 | Mid-process self-assessment | THIN | Real self-critique language only in Modules 3, 14, 18, 19; not course-wide. |
| VA.68.C.3.4 | Utilitarian vs. fine-art objects, social significance | NOT COVERED | Zero matches anywhere in the course. |
| VA.68.F.2.5 | Artist statement | COVERED | Every module's Week 2 file has a required, rubric-graded Artist Statement. |
| VA.68.F.3.1 | Technology + community/global concern | NOT COVERED | Module 17 (Digital Art) covers the technology half only; no community/global-concern content anywhere. |
| VA.68.H.1.4 | Personal-history connection | THIN | Real only in Module 12 (chair-as-self-portrait) and Module 20 (year-long growth reflection). Elsewhere the Artist Statement is technique-reflection only. |
| VA.68.H.3.2 | Critical-thinking / critique skills | COVERED | The Describe/Analyze/Interpret/Judge steps (unnamed to students) recur across instructional pages, e.g. Module 17's Dürer walkthrough. |
| VA.68.O.1.1 | Elements/principles unify artwork | COVERED | Constant throughout; every Week 2 rubric has an Elements & Principles row. |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| VA.68.O.1.3 | Creative + technical knowledge | **COVERED** | Every Week 2 rubric has separate Craftsmanship/Technique and Creative Problem-Solving rows. |
| VA.68.O.2.2 | Divergent thinking / multiple solutions | **NOT COVERED** | No brainstorming/multiple-options language found anywhere; students plan a single concept, not several. |
| VA.68.S.1.4 | Accurate art vocabulary | **COVERED** | Every instructional page has a "Vocabulary From This Lesson" box; rubrics grade vocabulary use. |
| VA.68.S.2.2 | Sequential procedures, specified media | **COVERED** | Every Week 2 "Student Directions" is a numbered step sequence with named media. |
| VA.68.S.2.3 | Sketchbook / visual-thinking journal | **COVERED** | Via the "art notebook" / Week 1 Sketch Assignment structure in every module. |
| VA.68.S.3.1 | 2D/3D materials and tools | **COVERED** | Course spans painting, watercolor, paper-mosaic, digital drawing, clay relief, relief printing, collage. |
| VA.68.S.3.3 | Safety protocols | **THIN** | Real safety language found only in Module 14. Absent in Module 11 (cutting), Module 18 (clay-carving tools), Module 3 (paper-cutting). |
| VA.68.S.3.5 | 2D techniques enhancing 3D artwork | **COVERED (narrow)** | Only in Module 18 Clay Relief (painting the dried relief). |
| MA.K12.MTR.1.1–7.1 | Cross-cutting math reasoning dispositions | **Plausible, generic** | Embedded via the course's iterative/reflective structure; no explicit trace expected or needed — cross-curricular disposition standard, not content-specific. |
| ELA.K12.EE.1.1 | Citing evidence | **Plausible** | Embedded via the critique method's "Judge" prompts. |
| ELA.K12.EE.4.1 | Collaborative discussion techniques | **INTENTIONAL GAP** | See callout below. |
| ELA.K12.EE.6.1 | Voice / tone | **COVERED** | Explicit "in your own voice" instructions in Artist Statements. |
| ELA.K12.EE.2.1 / 3.1 / 5.1 | (various) | **Thin/generic** | Not a priority for an art course. |
| ELD.K12.ELL.SI.1 | English-language-development | **Implicit** | Supported via consistent visual-first lesson design and in-context |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | support | vocabulary definition; not treated as a gap. |

FLAGGED FOR THE COURSE LEAD — INTENTIONAL, NOT AN OVERSIGHT

**ELA.K12.EE.4.1** (collaborative discussion techniques) is a confirmed gap that traces directly to two deliberate July 2026 revision decisions: removing the VR session (which used to host a spoken small-group critique) and removing the group/partner option from every module's intro survey. This was a considered trade-off at the time, not an oversight — but it means the course currently has no built-in collaborative-discussion component anywhere. The course lead should consciously decide whether to accept this trade-off going forward or design a replacement (e.g. a lightweight paired-critique option), rather than have it resurface as a surprise gap later.

## Prioritized punch list — what to revise first

1. **VA.68.C.3.4** — utilitarian vs. fine-art objects / social significance. Zero coverage; needs new content, likely a short module addition or an extended Artist Statement prompt somewhere in the course.
2. **VA.68.O.2.2** — divergent thinking / multiple solutions. Zero coverage; would need a brainstorm-multiple-options step added to at least one Week 2 assignment.
3. **VA.68.F.3.1** — technology + community/global concern. Module 17 has the technology half; the community/global-concern half needs to be added, most naturally to Module 17 itself.
4. **VA.68.S.3.3** — safety protocols. Add real safety language to Modules 3, 11, and 18 specifically (cutting and clay-carving tools), matching the language already present in Module 14.
5. **VA.68.H.1.4** — personal-history connection. Currently real only in Modules 12 and 20; consider extending to a few more Artist Statement prompts.
6. **VA.68.C.2.1** — mid-process self-assessment. Currently real only in Modules 3, 14, 18, 19; the Live-section adaptation in Section 14 offers one low-cost way to build this in live delivery even where the async version doesn't prompt it.

*Standard codes and verdicts in this section are teacher-manual-only and should never be echoed to students.*

SECTION 12

# What makes this course classical & cultivating culture

## What makes it classical

| Classical move | Where it actually appears in this build |
|---|---|
| Wonder before mechanism | The "What do you see? What do you notice? What do you wonder?" opening on every Look First step, before any analytical vocabulary is introduced. |
| Primary-source encounter, not a textbook stand-in | Every embeddable featured work is sourced from an actual museum collection (the Met, SFMOMA, the Art Institute of Chicago, the British Museum, the Library of Congress) rather than a generic illustration — this was the explicit subject of the July 2026 clip-art removal pass. |
| A method taught, not named | The Describe / Analyze / Interpret / Judge critique sequence is present in every module's "Watch It Work" section; the acronym that used to label it to students was deliberately removed, leaving the reasoning habit itself, per Optima's standing "teach the method, don't name it" rule. |
| The virtue thread | Every outro wrapper closes with a reflection on one of the seven virtues, with a module-specific suggested virtue (Section 2) that any honest, well-explained student choice can override. |
| Formation through craft, sustained over a year | Module 20's portfolio curation and growth reflection makes the whole year's formation visible to the student at once — "a year ago you opened your first folded booklet... look at what your hand can do now." |

## Cultivating culture asynchronously

- **The Commonplace Corner.** The course's own Canvas Home page carries a weekly "line worth keeping" — a quote from an artist or critic connected to the current module, with a short reflection prompt. Keep this genuinely rotating each week; it is the course's built-in habit of returning students to a real voice from the tradition, not a decoration.

- **Substantive feedback as relationship.** Since there is no discussion forum in this course, the rubric comment on the Week 2 Artist Statement is the main place a student hears a teacher's individual voice — treat it as a real response to their thinking, not a checklist tick.
- **Name good thinking publicly, sparingly.** When you do share strong student work as an example (per Section 8), say specifically what the student noticed or reasoned well — modeling the DAIJ habit in your own words keeps the method alive without naming it.
- **Hold the virtue thread visible.** Referencing a module's suggested virtue in the weekly announcement (Section 9) keeps the "art builds character, not just skill" framing present even though it's asynchronous.

SECTION 13

# Sensitive-content flags & family/student scripts

## Module 4 — Day of the Dead (Sugar Skulls)

**What it is:** Día de los Muertos, a real Mexican holiday of remembrance observed mainly November 1–2. The built lesson already carries strong, explicit neutral-setup framing: "*Día de los Muertos is treated in this module as a meaningful Mexican holiday of remembrance... It is not Halloween, not 'spooky,' and not a costume. The decorated skulls (calaveras) and bright colors celebrate memory, family, and life.*"

> SUGGESTED FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPT (editable)
>
> "Hi [families/students], next module we'll be studying Día de los Muertos (Day of the Dead), a Mexican holiday of remembrance observed each November. Students will learn about the tradition of the calavera (decorated skull) as a symbol of memory and celebration of life, not a scary or costume image, and will design their own in that spirit. This is part of our study of how art carries culture and meaning across the world. If you have any questions about this module, please reach out to me at [contact info] before we begin."

## Module 16 — Grant Wood (American Gothic Parody) — optional teacher-awareness note, not a family script

This one is **not flagged as sensitive content** — it is ordinary art history and does not need a family notice. Worth knowing as a teacher: the built lesson normalizes parody by noting how often *American Gothic* has been copied and joked about, but it does not include an explicit line about why it's acceptable to parody someone else's famous work, or any respect-for-the-original-artist framing. If a student or parent asks "is it okay to make fun of someone else's painting," a ready answer is that parody of a widely-known, decades-old public-domain work is a long-standing, respected artistic tradition (think of how many artists have riffed on this exact painting), and the goal of the assignment is creative reinterpretation, not mockery.

## Other content reviewed

Nothing else in the sampled modules warranted a flag. Modules with living or rights-managed artists (11, 14, 15, 19) are handled as a copyright/media-literacy convention (Section 2), not a content-sensitivity issue. Modules 9's Rembrandt/chiaroscuro content and Module 17's Dürer self-portrait carry no sensitive material.

SECTION 14 · ADDED FOR THIS COURSE

# Adapting the weekly cadence for a Live section meeting four days a week

> **A PLANNING TOOL, NOT A CONTENT CHANGE**
>
> Everything in this section is a teacher day-by-day delivery plan for teachers running a synchronous Live section. The built Canvas assignments and files are identical for On-Demand and Live students — nothing described here changes what gets built or graded. It only changes how a Live teacher paces the same five components across real class meetings.

Map the async 2-week / 10-day module cycle onto 8 live class sessions (4 days a week, across 2 weeks):

| Session | What happens in class |
|---|---|
| **Week 1, Day 1** | Students complete the Intro survey individually at the start of class. Teacher leads the "notice and wonder" opening on the module's featured artwork, then delivers direct instruction on the day's Elements/Principles/technique content from the instructional page. |
| **Week 1, Day 2** | Direct instruction continues, including the Describe/Analyze/Interpret/Judge critique walkthrough (still unnamed to students). Guided practice on the Sketch Assignment begins in class with the teacher circulating. |
| **Week 1, Day 3** | Students finish the Sketch Assignment in class with teacher support, then take the Week 1 Quiz in class (same content as the at-home auto-graded version, just completed synchronously). |
| **Week 1, Day 4** | Teacher demonstrates the Week 2 studio technique and distributes materials; students begin their finished artwork under direct supervision. This session matters most for modules needing hands-on safety guidance (cutting tools in Modules 3, 11; clay-carving tools in Module 18) or a teacher demonstration (watercolor wet-on-wet in Module 10, relief printing in Module 15). |
| **Week 2, Days 5–7** | Studio work time on the finished artwork, with the teacher circulating for in-process self-assessment and critique conversations. This is also the natural place to build in live, spoken self-assessment practice — the currently-thin |

| | |
|---|---|
| | **VA.68.C.2.1** standard (Section 11) — even in modules where the async version doesn't prompt it. |
| **Week 2, Day 8** | Finish/dry time if needed, write and submit the Artist Statement in class, complete the Outro survey as a group close, and — time permitting — a short teacher-led share of 2–3 students' finished pieces. |

DRYING-TIME MODULES — SHIFT THE PACING

Modules with a drying-time material need the Week 2 studio session to start a day earlier in live pacing, so the piece has time to dry before the Artist Statement session: **Module 18** (clay), and the wet-media Modules **10** (watercolor) and **11** (paint). In these three, consider starting the studio demonstration on Week 1, Day 4 as planned, but moving the hands-on start earlier within that session, or trading a Week 2 review day for drying time so the Day 8 Artist Statement session isn't rushed.